

ScriptLens — Error Type Examples for Dataset Creators

Side-by-side reference from the genre starter pack

Who this is for: Writers and editors building test scripts for ScriptLens.

What you get: Thirteen continuity-error types, each with a **clean** 5-scene (or 10-scene excerpt) example and the **same script with one error planted**. Yellow highlighting marks lines that changed.

Source files: Clean scripts in `docs/genre_starter_scripts/`; planted versions in `tests/corpus/input/`.

Before you plant errors

- Start from a **clean starter** — do not rewrite the whole story.
- Change only what you need: usually **one phrase or action line** per error.
- **Establish** the fact early; **break** it in a later scene (see scene numbers).
- Write in natural production prose — no labels like “CONTINUITY ERROR HERE.”
- Log every planted error in your answer sheet (type, establish scene, break scene).
- Do **not** plant intentional character arcs (enemies→friends, divorce, etc.).

Scene numbering

Scene numbers match ScriptLens reports: **1-indexed** by order of `INT . / EXT .` headings (first heading = scene 1).

1. Prop — wrong owner (object_ownership)

Reference script: BREACH POINT (5 scenes) | **Genre:** Action | **Establish scene 2 → Break scene 5**

A prop is clearly on one person, then another person has it with no handoff scene.

How to plant: Establish who carries the prop in an early scene. Later, a different character uses or owns the same prop without a give/take/find scene.

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 2 A RED FLARE CANISTER clips to Vega's vest.	Scene 2 A RED FLARE CANISTER clips to Vega's vest.
Scene 5 Santos pops the RED FLARE.	Scene 5 Santos pulls his own RED FLARE and pops it.

2. Numeric count mismatch (numeric_count)

Reference script: BREACH POINT (5 scenes) | **Genre:** Action | **Establish scene 1 → Break scene 5**

A headcount or quantity is stated one way, then contradicted later.

How to plant: State a number in scene 1 (and optionally repeat it). Break the same count in a later scene — e.g. three hostages, then “all four.”

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
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Scene 1 A HOSTAGE COUNT reads 3 in a basement vault.	Scene 1 A HOSTAGE COUNT reads 3 in a basement vault.
Scene 3 Three HOSTAGES crouch against a steel cage.	Scene 3 Three HOSTAGES crouch against a steel cage.
Scene 5 Count them. All three. Then we celebrate.	Scene 5 Count them. All four. Then we celebrate.

3. Character age slip (character_age)

Reference script: THE WEIGHT OF WATER (5 scenes) | Genre: Drama | Establish scene 2 → Break scene 3

A character's age is set in one scene, then a different age appears.

How to plant: Introduce age in a character line (e.g. "Sofia, 12"). Later, dialogue or action implies a different age for the same person.

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 2 Elena's daughter SOFIA, 12, does homework.	Scene 2 Elena's daughter SOFIA, 12, does homework.
Scene 3 She's fast when she's not looking over her shoulder.	Scene 3 She's the fastest ten-year-old in the lane when she's not looking over her shoulder.

4. Prop identity change (object_identity)

Reference script: SECOND COAST (5 scenes) | Genre: Romance | Establish scene 1 → Break scene 5

The same prop changes material, colour, or description.

How to plant: Describe a prop clearly once (leather satchel). Later refer to the same prop with a conflicting descriptor (canvas satchel).

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 1 James ... carrying a battered LEATHER SATCHEL.	Scene 1 James ... carrying a battered LEATHER SATCHEL.
Scene 5 The satchel lies open between them ...	Scene 5 The canvas satchel lies open between them ...

5. Character role / trait clash (character_trait_conflict)

Reference script: SECOND COAST (5 scenes) | Genre: Romance | Establish scene 1 → Break scene 4

A character's job or defining trait contradicts an earlier statement.

How to plant: State a profession or trait early (novelist). Later call the same character something incompatible (the poet) without a story reason.

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
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Scene 1 CLAIRE HART, 32, novelist, sips coffee.	Scene 1 CLAIRE HART, 32, novelist, sips coffee.
Scene 4 Claire opens it a crack. James holds two paper cups of tea.	Scene 4 Claire, the poet, sets down her pen and opens it a crack.

6. Character knows too early (character_knowledge)

Reference script: BASEMENT TAPE (5 scenes) | **Genre:** Horror | **Establish scene 4 → Break scene 5**

Someone references a fact before the story has revealed it to them.

How to plant: In one scene, treat a detail as unfamiliar (“never noticed”). In a later scene, the same character acts as if they always knew it (“stepped over a thousand times”).

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 4 Footsteps creak overhead — but Leah lives alone.	Scene 4 Leah steadies herself on the rail above the old trapdoor she's stepped over a thousand times.
Scene 5 ...pointing at the floor trapdoor Leah never noticed.	Scene 5 ...pointing at the floor trapdoor Leah never noticed.

7. Date or year mismatch (date_year)

Reference script: BASEMENT TAPE (5 scenes) | **Genre:** Horror | **Establish scene 2 → Break scene 3**

A label, slug, or line gives one year; later text gives another.

How to plant: Put a year on a prop label or scene heading. Later dialogue or action states a different year for the same item or event.

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 2 A tape labeled CHRISTMAS '94 plays ...	Scene 2 A tape labeled CHRISTMAS '94 plays ...
Scene 3 Leah checks the tape label again. CHRISTMAS '94.	Scene 3 Leah checks the tape label again. CHRISTMAS '93.

8. Relationship contradiction (relationship_fact)

Reference script: THE GROOMSMEN'S GUIDE (5 scenes) | **Genre:** Comedy | **Establish scene 3 → Break scene 4**

Two characters are related one way, then described differently.

How to plant: Establish a family tie in natural dialogue (future mother-in-law). Later call the same person a different relation (aunt) with no explanation.

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 3 Dave's future mother-in-law DIANE inspects place cards.	Scene 3 Dave's future mother-in-law DIANE inspects place cards.

Scene 4
PETE irons a sash.

Scene 4
Dave's aunt Diane straightens a centerpiece ...

9. Character fact slip (character_fact)

Reference script: SENIOR WEEK (5 scenes) | **Genre:** Coming-of-age | **Establish scene 2 → Break scene 5**

A stable fact about a character (plans, destination) changes.

How to plant: State where a character is headed (state school). Later the same character says the opposite destination (coast school).

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 2 State school for me. Coast for you.	Scene 2 State school for me. Coast for you.
Scene 5 Same thing if you're paying attention.	Scene 5 Coast school for me starts in August, so we'd better mean it.

10. Location / direction clash (location_continuity)

Reference script: THE THRESHOLD (5 scenes) | **Genre:** Supernatural | **Establish scene 2 → Break scene 5**

The script treats one place as a single location, then labels that same place with a conflicting compass direction — not two different rooms.

How to plant: First anchor ONE location: scene 1 says “Same bedroom, same story”; scenes 2–3 use the east bedroom and its threshold. Scene 5 repeats the same discovery beat (drawing under the floorboard) but the slug flips to WEST BEDROOM — as if the haunted room moved, with no scene showing Elise changed rooms. A real house may have both an east and a west bedroom; this error only works when the story clearly means the same room.

Not an error if the script clearly introduces two separate bedrooms. Plant this only when direction/slug contradicts an already-established single place.

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 1 Same bedroom, same story.	Scene 1 Same bedroom, same story.
Scene 2 The THRESHOLD of the east bedroom glows faintly ...	Scene 2 The THRESHOLD of the east bedroom glows faintly ...
Scene 3 INT. EAST BEDROOM - NIGHT	Scene 3 INT. EAST BEDROOM - NIGHT
Scene 5 INT. EAST BEDROOM - NIGHT — Elise finds a child's DRAWING ...	Scene 5 INT. WEST BEDROOM - NIGHT — Elise finds a child's DRAWING ...

11. Name spelling drift (name_consistency)

Reference script: BREACH POINT (10 scenes — excerpt) | **Genre:** Action | **Establish scene 4 → Break scene 7**

The same character's name is spelled differently in different scenes.

How to plant: Use a consistent spelling for a character name in early scenes. Later introduce a misspelling or alternate spelling for the same person.

No 5-scene example in the reference corpus; this excerpt is from the 10-scene action starter.

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 4 Osei disables a camera with a pellet.	Scene 4 Osei disables a camera with a pellet.
Scene 7 Osei shields the civilians.	Scene 7 Oshea shields the civilians.

12. Physical fact contradiction (fact_consistency)

Reference script: MANOR KEY (10 scenes — excerpt) | Genre: Mystery | Establish scene 5 → Break scene 10

Two physical facts about the same thing cannot both be true.

How to plant: State a measurable fact (print smaller than a boot). Later assert the opposite (print matched exactly) with no intervening explanation.

No 5-scene example in the reference corpus; this excerpt is from the 10-scene mystery starter.

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 5 Quinn finds a muddy partial print — smaller than Tomas's boot.	Scene 5 Quinn finds a muddy partial print — smaller than Tomas's boot.
Scene 10 The key didn't leave. You moved it to delay the reading.	Scene 10 The print on the stair matched Tomas exactly. And a nineteen-year-old gardener didn't revise your insurance.

13. Injury location slip (medical_state)

Reference script: NO MAN'S LAND (10 scenes — excerpt) | Genre: War | Establish scene 8 → Break scene 9

An injury is described on one part of the body, then treated elsewhere.

How to plant: Describe where a character is wounded (shoulder). In the next scene, medical care targets a different body part (leg) with no correction.

No 5-scene example in the reference corpus; this excerpt is from the 10-scene war starter.

Clean starter (correct continuity)	Same script with this error planted
Scene 8 Kowalski hit, shoulder.	Scene 8 Kowalski hit, shoulder.
Scene 9 Medics take Kowalski.	Scene 9 Medics bind Kowalski's leg.

Quick checklist for submitters

- Two errors per 5-scene script; three per 10-scene script.

- Errors spread across different scenes — not all in scene 5.
- Each error logged with type, establish scene, break scene, and exact lines.
- Script reads like a real draft; only the logged lines contain mistakes.

Generated by `scripts/build_error_type_examples_guide.py` · Full planted-error index: `tests/corpus/PLANTED_ERROR_LOG.md`